

roof. What this ensures is that there are no incompatibilities between the hardware and the software, which results in a rock-solid system. It is a pretty simple concept expertly implemented.

5.5 Advantages And Disadvantages

5.5.1 Disadvantages

All Macs, with the exception of the Power Mac, offer the user an extremely limited scope of upgrading the machine. The only thing you can upgrade on them is the memory and storage. If you want an extra SuperDrive, you will have to do with an external one. If you want to upgrade to a better processor or graphics card, you'll need to buy a new machine. This is acceptable on laptops because laptops from other companies don't offer much scope for upgrading the machine either, but the fact that you cannot pop in a better processor in your iMac or Mac Mini once it is outdated acts as a strong deterrent for potential switchers.

5.5.2 Advantages

The first point has to be the competitive customer care Apple provides for their users. There have been a good number of cases where Apple did something to help a customer that was as unexpected as it was helpful. People send in their notebooks for small problems and Apple sometimes not only replaces them, but replaces them with the latest model of the product. They have a policy: if you purchase a new Mac and a revised version is launched within a month of purchase, Apple will replace your Mac with one of the newer models free of cost. They have a toll free number attended by people who actually know what they are talking about. Apple was the company that started the norm of giving a standard warranty of one year on their products at a time when all other companies gave a warranty of ninety days. AppleCare can also be extended to three years of complete support over the phone and onsite troubleshooting.

In a shootout of laptops, we had this to say about the Apple PowerBook—"The Apple PowerBook G4 was in a league of its own.